DAPPER DETAILING PROS

INTERIOR DETAIL SOP

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1 MASTER SOP — INTERIOR DETAILING (ALL VEHICLE TYPES)

1.1 PURPOSE

This SOP ensures consistent, high-quality interior detailing across all vehicle types while maintaining efficiency, safety, and complete coverage of all areas. The goal is to eliminate missed spots, reduce rework, and standardize technician performance.

1.2 ROLES & RESPONSIBILITY

Role	Responsibility
Detail Technician	Executes full SOP and ensures quality standards are met
QC Lead / Supervisor	Performs final inspection and approves delivery

1.3 STANDARD TIME TARGETS

Vehicle Type	Time (1 Tech)	Time (2 Techs)
Hatchback	1.5–2 hrs	1–1.25 hrs
Sedan	2–2.5 hrs	1.25–1.75 hrs
SUV	2.5–3.5 hrs	1.5–2.5 hrs
Pickup Truck	2–3 hrs	1.25–2 hrs
Bus / Large Van	4–6 hrs	3–4 hrs
Trailer / Specialty	Case-based	Case-based

1.4 REQUIRED EQUIPMENT

All tools must be prepared before starting the job to avoid workflow interruptions.

- Vacuum (strong suction)
- Air compressor or Tornador
- Microfiber towels (minimum 10 per job)
- APC (All Purpose Cleaner)
- Upholstery/carpet cleaner
- Leather cleaner and conditioner
- Glass cleaner
- Soft and medium brushes
- Drill brush for heavy jobs
- Steam cleaner (if available)

1.5 NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

All technicians must follow these rules without exception:

- No cross-contamination (interior towels only)
- Always work from top to bottom
- Always follow dry → wet → dry workflow
- Never soak electronics or sensitive areas
- All customer belongings must be bagged and labeled

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2 PROCESS FLOW

2.1 STEP 1: VEHICLE PREP (5–10 MIN)

The vehicle must be prepared before cleaning begins to ensure an efficient workflow. All doors should be opened to allow full access. Floor mats must be removed, and all visible trash should be cleared.

Customer belongings must be collected carefully, placed in a bag, and labeled.

A quick condition scan must be performed to identify heavy stains, pet hair, or odor issues. These observations help determine effort level and necessary focus areas.

2.2 STEP 2: DRY CLEANING (MOST IMPORTANT PHASE)

This step removes all loose debris before any liquid is introduced. Skipping or rushing this phase will reduce overall quality and increase cleaning time later.

2.2.1 Blow-Out

Use compressed air to loosen debris from tight and hidden areas including seat seams, under seats, console gaps, door pockets, and vents. This step significantly improves efficiency and reduces cleaning time.

2.2.2 Vacuuming

Vacuuming must follow a structured order to ensure full coverage:

Order	Area
1	Headliner edges (light pass only)
2	Seats (top to bottom)
3	Between seat gaps
4	Carpets

5	Under seats
6	Trunk / cargo

2.2.3 Vehicle-Specific Focus

Different vehicle types require additional attention:

- SUV / Pickup: deeper debris under seats and rear cargo hair buildup
- Bus / Van: seat rails and high foot-traffic zones
- Trailer: dust-heavy surfaces

2.3 STEP 3: SURFACE CLEANING (TOP → DOWN)

Surface cleaning must only begin after complete vacuuming. Steam is used as a support tool to loosen dirt and must always be followed by immediate wiping.

2.3.1 Headliner

The headliner is a sensitive surface and must be handled carefully. Use a lightly damp microfiber towel and wipe gently. Scrubbing or steam use is not allowed, as it may cause sagging or adhesive failure.

2.3.2 Dashboard, Console, and Vents

Apply short bursts of steam to vents, seams, buttons, and cup holders while maintaining a distance of 2–4 inches. Use a detailing brush for light agitation to lift dirt.

Follow this by wiping all surfaces using APC applied to a microfiber towel (never spray directly onto surfaces). This includes the dashboard, steering wheel, infotainment system, and center console.

Direct steam on electronics or screens is not allowed.

2.3.3 Door Panels

Door panels should be treated with light steam on high-contact areas such as handles, armrests, and storage compartments. Clean using APC and finish with a dry microfiber wipe.

2.3.4 Seats (Fabric and Leather)

Seat Type	Process
Fabric Seats	Apply light steam to stains and seams, then apply fabric cleaner, agitate with brush, and extract or wipe
Leather Seats	Optional light steam (quick pass only), apply leather cleaner, use soft brush, wipe dry, then apply conditioner

2.3.5 Key Rules

- Do not oversaturate any surface
- Avoid prolonged steam exposure
- Avoid heat buildup on leather

2.3.6 Final Surface Check

All cleaned surfaces must be inspected to ensure:

- No residue remains
- No moisture is left sitting
- No streaks or missed areas

Technician Standard: Steam → Agitate → Wipe

2.4 STEP 4: CARPET & FLOOR CLEANING

Carpet cleaning involves applying carpet cleaner, agitating the surface (manually or using a drill brush), and extracting or wiping the residue. This process should be repeated until the desired cleanliness is achieved.

For heavy conditions:

- Pet hair requires rubber brush and air combination
- Mud requires pre-scraping and multiple cleaning passes

2.5 STEP 5: DETAILING TOUCH AREAS

Certain areas are commonly missed and must always be included in the detailing process. These include seatbelt straps, cup holders, gear shift, steering wheel stitching, AC vents, and door jamb interiors.

2.6 STEP 6: GLASS CLEANING (FINAL STEP)

Glass cleaning must always be performed last to avoid contamination. Use a clean microfiber towel and apply cleaner to the towel rather than directly onto the glass.

All interior glass surfaces including windshield, side windows, and rear glass must be cleaned thoroughly.

2.7 STEP 7: ODOR TREATMENT (IF REQUIRED)

If odor issues are present, apply odor neutralizer or perform ozone treatment depending on severity and availability.

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2.8 STEP 8: FINAL FINISH

The final step ensures presentation quality. Reinstall cleaned mats, align seats properly, and perform a final wipe on all touchpoints.

The vehicle should appear clean, symmetrical, and ready for delivery.

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3 FINAL QC CHECKLIST

Category	Standard
Visual	No dust, stains, or streaks
Touch	Surfaces dry with no residue or stickiness
Smell	Fresh and neutral scent

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4 COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping blow-out step
- Over-wetting seats
- Using dirty towels
- Ignoring tight or hidden areas
- Rushing glass cleaning